EL NIÑO ACTION BRIEFING · 21 OCTOBER 2026

Aljada, Muwaileh, Sharjah

Here El Niño brings rain rather than heat, and in Sharjah the rain kills on the road. Sharjah should decide on remote work and school closures the evening before a storm, not on the morning of it.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Not resolved (Sharjah emirate)	No figure published for the UAE	Flood risk Oct 2026 – May 2027; peak risk Feb – Apr 2027	Flash flooding, with power cuts and dengue in its wake

13/13 recommendations checked. 7 corrected, 2 unverified, and 4 contraindicated (the "Do not" cards). Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review). It names no Gulf country, and in any case it covers heat only, which is not this place's El Niño hazard. The rain hazard is carried here by the historical record and by the UAE National Center of Meteorology (NCM) outlook. The NCM gives a 96% probability of El Niño conditions from November 2026 to March 2027, with near- or above-average rain "particularly towards the latter part of the forecast period". It does not forecast flooding.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



25.32°N 55.48°E, United Arab Emirates · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** El Niño brings Sharjah rain, not heat. All four UAE deaths in the April 2024 floods involved vehicles, and the worst storms on record came in February to April of El Niño years.
- **First action.** By 15 November, Sharjah's emergency team commits to calling remote work and distance learning the evening before any NCM orange or red rain alert.
- **The money.** AED 150,000 floor, AED 1.38 million target, AED 5.48 million ceiling (US$40,800 / US$375,800 / US$1.49 million). Warden kits for 1,000 households are placed first.
- **Do not.** Never wait in a stalled car with the engine running and the windows shut. Two women died that way in Sharjah in April 2024.*

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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHAT THIS PLACE IS, AND WHAT IT IS NOT

SCOPE

The request named a residential building in **Aljada**, Arada's master community. Aljada covers about 224 hectares in Muwaileh, beside University City, between Al Dhaid Road and University City Road, and is planned for about 70,000 residents. This briefing covers Aljada and the Muwaileh roads around it; a single building is too fine a unit for the evidence.

One finding shapes everything below. **No report in English or Arabic shows Aljada or Muwaileh itself flooding** in January 2020, April 2024, or March 2026. In the record, Aljada is where Sharjah *shelters* people: its Nest complex took in 1,148 people in 2022, opened up to 3,000 places in 2024, and housed 387 people in 2026. The danger for Aljada's residents is the commute into flooded parts of the city, power and lift failure, mosquitoes after the rain, and food supply. Water inside their own buildings is the smaller risk. If Aljada's own streets do flood this winter, actions 3 and 5 matter more than their rank suggests.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO

RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached independently is the stronger bet.

1. Call remote work and distance learning the evening before any NCM orange or red rain alert, as a standing rule agreed by 15 November

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | HISTORIAN · EMERGENCY MANAGER · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT ACCESSIBLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sharjah Local Emergency, Crisis and Disaster Management Team, with the Sharjah Department of Human Resources and the Sharjah Private Education Authority (SPEA)	**Rule agreed by 15 Nov 2026; applied on every alert to May 2027**	**None; it is a decision**	**People being trapped in cars on flooded roads, which is where every 2024 UAE flood death occurred**

Sharjah has done this before. Its Department of Human Resources ordered remote work on 15 April 2024 for 16–17 April, and the Local Emergency, Crisis and Disaster Management Team called distance learning and remote work on 1 May 2024 for 2–3 May. What is missing is a *rule*. In March 2026 the HR department only *authorised* departments to arrange remote work at their heads' discretion, and people

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

were caught on the roads. The Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratisation (MoHRE) urged private employers to allow "remote or flexible working arrangements where required" in March 2026. It did not ask them to stop outdoor or delivery work, so that would be a new ask. A fixed 6pm announcement time is also new: no precedent sets one.

Transferability: strong, because the precedent is Sharjah's own. No study measures the deaths averted, but the causal chain is short: all four UAE deaths in April 2024 involved a vehicle.

2. Put one plain car-safety message, in seven languages, behind every NCM orange and red alert from 31 October

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE · EMERGENCY MANAGER · PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT ACCESSIBLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sharjah Police, relayed by Aljada building management and diaspora associations	**31 Oct 2026, then on every alert**	**No quote; translation and relay by permitted volunteer teams**	**Carbon monoxide deaths in queued cars, and cars driven into underpasses and wadis**

The message: *"Don't drive into water or underpasses. If you're stuck in traffic, switch the engine off and open a window. Never sit sealed in a running car. If water is rising around the car, get out early. Never walk or drive through moving water."* It goes out in Arabic, English, Hindi, Urdu, Malayalam, Tagalog, and Bengali. It should go through building WhatsApp groups, employers, delivery platforms, and associations such as the Indian Association Sharjah, which ran buses, kitchens, and helplines in 2024. Every relay repeats the police wording exactly. The evidence that vehicles are where people die in floods is strong: 49% of Australian flood deaths in 1960–2015, and over half of US flood drownings. The evidence that warning campaigns change behaviour is not: "Turn Around, Don't Drown" has never been evaluated for outcomes.*

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: the cause of death is local and confirmed by Sharjah Police. The campaign's effect is unmeasured anywhere. An earlier draft said to leave the car "if the water is still and below knee height"; no official source supports a depth rule, so it was removed. The US National Weather Service warns that 15 cm of fast water knocks an adult over and 30 cm carries most cars away.

3. Give every Aljada building a flood protocol by 15 November: a warden, a list of who needs help, cars out of the basements, and lifts parked high

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | SKEPTIC · EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN · FRONTLINE · PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT ACCESSIBLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Arada community and facilities management	15 Nov 2026	Staff time; warden kits in placement 1	Deaths in basements and from live power, and residents stranded in towers without lifts, water, or power

- **A warden per building** keeps a register of residents who are elderly, disabled, living alone, caring for newborns, or on dialysis or insulin, and knocks on their doors when the power goes. A volunteer warden team needs a permit from the Sharjah Centre for Volunteer Work (at least five founders, and an individual permit for each member).
- **At an NCM orange alert,** residents move cars out of the basement levels 24–48 hours ahead, and then the ramps close. One listing says the Link buildings have two basement parking levels; Arada should confirm this.
- **Lifts are parked on upper floors,** and ground-floor and basement switchrooms are isolated by the building's own electrician. The Sharjah Electricity, Water and Gas Authority (SEWA) restores power after a failure; it does not isolate buildings before one. Drinking water is stored above pump level.

The evidence: in Valencia in October 2024, 32 of 218 flood dead were found in garages and car parks. During New York's 2003 blackout, accidental deaths rose 122% (95% CI 28–287%; Anderson & Bell, *Epidemiology* 2012). In April 2024, Sharjah towers lost power, water, and lifts for days. In February 2010 three people died in Sharjah from live wires in floodwater, and in December 2025 two more were electrocuted in the industrial area during rain-driven outages. No Civil Defence or SEWA rule covers this at building level, so this action fills a gap rather than duplicating one.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: the basement evidence is Spanish, and no UAE basement death is on record. The electrocution risk is local and recurrent. After Hurricane Sandy, dialysis patients had more emergency visits and slightly higher 30-day mortality (Kelman et al., *AJKD* 2015): a small effect, from a US hurricane.

4. Turn the Nest's three ad-hoc shelter openings into a written trigger: an NCM orange or red alert opens it, by agreement signed by 15 November

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST · FOOD · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT ACCESSIBLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sharjah Social Services Department (SSSD), with the Arada Foundation and Sharjah Civil Defence	Signed by 15 Nov 2026	Arada has covered every opening in kind; overflow beds and meals in placement 3	The days-long lag between the storm and the first families moving in

The Nest in Aljada has sheltered Sharjah three times. In April 2022 it took 1,148 people. In April 2024, Arada and SSSD opened up to 3,000 places, but the first families moved in only on 22 April, six days after the rain, and no occupancy count was ever published. In March 2026 it housed 387 people (363 adults and 24 children) on full board from 25 to 31 March, with SSSD and Civil Defence. Each opening was improvised and paid for "wherever possible" from the Arada Foundation's emergency fund. No standing agreement exists. Writing one down means the trigger, intake, and priority list (children, older people, and people of determination) are settled before the rain, so families can move in on day one.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: this is Aljada's own precedent. Pre-positioned food parcels could be added to the agreement. In 2024, Arada's 6,500 parcels went to central Sharjah (Abu Shagara, Qasimia, and Al Majaz), not to Aljada.

5. Name Muwaileh and Aljada's access roads in Sharjah Municipality's rain plan, and have Arada map Aljada's own ponding points, by 15 November

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT ACCESSIBLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sharjah Municipality; Arada facilities management for the map	15 Nov 2026	Within the existing rain plan; no separate quote	Roads that stay flooded for days, which is what traps people in cars

Sharjah Municipality's rain plan already exists: in March 2026 it fielded 1,200 staff, 180 tankers, and 140 pumps. The new AED 500 million Middle Line drainage project is 70% complete and due in February 2027. It serves 22 central areas (King Abdulaziz, King Faisal, the Corniche, and Al Majaz) and reaches Muwaileh only in a later phase. So through this El Niño, Muwaileh depends on tankers and pumps, not new drains. An earlier draft put a cost of AED 1.5 million on this action; it had no source and was removed.

Transferability: no source shows these roads flooding, so the ponding points are an assumption until Arada maps them from its own 2024 and 2026 photographs.

6. Clear standing water within 7 days of each heavy rain and weekly until it is gone, and test fevers for dengue

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT ACCESSIBLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sharjah Municipality Health Control and Safety Department, with Arada facilities management, volunteer teams, and Emirates Health Services (EHS)	Within 7 days of each heavy rain, Oct 2026 – May 2027	Within existing municipal campaigns; volunteer time	A post-flood dengue wave of the kind that followed April 2024

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

After April 2024, the UAE health ministry ordered immediate reporting of dengue cases, hospitals saw local cases in people with no travel history, and a national campaign removed 409 breeding sites. No official case total was ever released. *Aedes aegypti* is confirmed established in Dubai, with dengue virus found in mosquito pools (CDC, *Emerging Infectious Diseases*, August 2026). The Health Control and Safety Department already ran post-rain mosquito campaigns in 2024 and March 2026. This action points them at basements, podiums, construction pits, and building surrounds in Aljada, and shortens the window: *Aedes* goes from egg to adult in 7–10 days, so 14 days is too slow. Ask EHS whether dengue testing is free for low-wage workers and delivery riders. No source says it is.

Transferability: the best trial, Camino Verde (Andersson et al., *BMJ* 2015; Nicaragua and Mexico), cut recent infections in children by 29.5% (95% CI 3.8–55.3) and pupae by 51.7%. It tested household and community mobilisation against domestic containers, not municipal clearance of basements. It supports the volunteer part of this action, not the rest.

7. Propose to Sharjah Charity International a cash bridge for uninsured renters and low-wage workers, released on an alert rather than a damage survey, agreed before February

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT ACCESSIBLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sharjah Charity International (SCI), with SSSD	**Agreed by 31 Jan 2027, before the February – April window**	**AED 600,000 (US$163,400) for 300 households at AED 2,000**	**Renters going unpaid or paid months late, as in 2024**

After 2024, public money went to citizens and homeowners. The federal AED 2 billion was for citizens' homes. Sharjah's AED 15.33 million (618 cases) and AED 49.69 million (1,806 cases) went to owners of damaged homes, paid months after assessment. Aljada's residents are mostly expatriate renters, and in a survey from about 2013, only 4% of UAE tenants held contents cover. SCI already gives cash: AED 6.7 million in zakat cash to 4,538 cases in the first half of 2026. But in the March 2026 rain it reached only 35 families, after household visits. No charity has a trigger-based fund. This is a proposal, and 300 households would be about nine times SCI's observed rain caseload.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: the legal route is sound. Only licensed bodies such as SCI may raise funds (Federal Law No. 3 of 2021). The release on an alert is untested here. A parametric rainfall policy for renters was also proposed. None is sold at retail in the UAE, and one cannot be built before this peak, so it is a question for after the season.

8. Ask employers of workers in labour accommodation to hold a 7-day dry-ration and water buffer per worker by 30 November, restocked by 1 February for Ramadan

UNVERIFIED | FOOD SUPPLY | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT ACCESSIBLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
MoHRE (by circular), carried out by employers	30 Nov 2026; restock by 1 Feb 2027	About AED 70–100 (US$19–27) per worker, estimated	Camp kitchens running dry when catering trucks cannot move

MoHRE's rules (Ministerial Resolution 44/2022 and the 2026 accommodation standards) require food facilities, water, and emergency plans, but no stock. In April 2024, groceries closed, shelves were "largely empty", and delivery apps cut service. Ramadan is expected from about 8 February to 8 or 9 March 2027, inside the riskiest rain window. The food lens found that workers who eat from employer catering are the ones who eat last when roads close.

Unverified: no evidence measures the effect of such a buffer, and the unit cost is an estimate. It is ranked low for that reason. It stays in because its cost is small and the gap it fills is real.

9. Agree a flood-priority route for food trucks from Khor Fakkan, and stage stock on the Gulf side of the Hajar mountains, by 31 January

UNVERIFIED | FOOD SUPPLY | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NOT ACCESSIBLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Sharjah Local Emergency, Crisis and Disaster Management Team, with Sharjah Police and Gulftainer (the Khor Fakkan port operator)	31 Jan 2027	Not costed	One storm cutting the route that most of Sharjah's imported food now travels

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

This is the El Niño risk most specific to 2026. Since the war began on 28 February 2026, the Strait of Hormuz has been contested: commercial transits are about 3–5 a day (IMF PortWatch), against more than 85 before, and attacks peaked this October. UAE cargo now lands at Khor Fakkan and Fujairah and is trucked over the mountains, at 5–15% higher cost (March 2026). Khor Fakkan Road closed in both directions in the July 2022 floods. The UAE imports about 85–90% of its food and says its reserves cover 4–6 months. Nobody has a staged stock or a flood-priority corridor yet.

Unverified: feasible, but there is no precedent or evaluation. El Niño's own food signal here is weak: India's rice crop is forecast down 7 million tonnes, but no export curb has been notified. The real risk is a storm landing on a supply route the war has already narrowed.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	Emergency Team	HR Dept / SPEA	Sharjah Police	Municipality	SEWA	SSSD	Arada	SCI	EHS	MoHRE	Employers	Associations
1. Remote work called the evening before	A	R	C				I			R	I	I
2. Seven-language car-safety message	C		A/R				R			I	R	R
3. Building flood protocol					C	C	A/R					R
4. Nest shelter trigger	C		I			A	R	R				I
5. Muwaileh in the rain plan; ponding map	C		I	A/R			R					
6. Standing water cleared; dengue testing				A/R			R		R	I		R
7. Cash bridge for renters						C	C	A/R				C
8. Ration buffer in labour accommodation						I				A	R	
9. Food-truck priority route and staged stock	A		R	I		I						

What the chart shows: Arada appears in seven of nine rows, more than any public body, because Aljada is private land and its shelter is Arada's building. The Emergency Team and Sharjah Municipality are each accountable for two rows. Rows 1, 3, and 4 need a decision, not money: a rule, a protocol, and a signed agreement.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs.

FLOOR

AED 150,000 (US$40,800)

TARGET

AED 1,380,000 (US$375,800)

CEILING

AED 5,480,000 (US$1.49 million)

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY

How many people are displaced: 387 in 2026, against up to 3,000 places opened in 2024

Floor: warden kits AED 80,000, plus cash for 35 households at AED 2,000 (SCI's observed rain caseload) = AED 70,000. Total AED 150,000. **Target:** kits AED 80,000 + cash for 300 households AED 600,000 + overflow shelter for 500 people × 7 nights × AED 200 = AED 700,000. Total AED 1,380,000. **Ceiling:** kits AED 80,000 + cash for 600 households AED 1,200,000 + shelter for 3,000 × 7 × AED 200 = AED 4,200,000. Total AED 5,480,000. The target moved 1% in verification, from the lens's AED 1,400,000. Two changes cancelled out: a AED 75,000 warnings grant was dropped because alerts are a police and NCM function, and the shelter rate rose from AED 150 to AED 200 per person-night, the Nest's

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own room-plus-board price. Unit prices are estimates. The state already pays for drains, pumps, rescue, and citizens' homes, so no placement funds those.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
Sharjah Charity International, with permitted volunteer teams	Action 3: warden kits (power bank, torch, printed register) for 1,000 vulnerable households	AED 80,000 (US$21,800)	Direct grant	1,000 × AED 80, estimated. Outage harm: Anderson & Bell 2012 (New York); Sharjah towers without lifts in 2024	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
Sharjah Charity International	Action 7: cash bridge for uninsured renters and low-wage workers	AED 600,000 (US$163,400)	Cash transfer, released on an alert	300 × AED 2,000. Renters were outside every 2024 public payment. No published cost per life; it protects livelihoods more than lives	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
Sharjah Charity International, for SSSD's intake at the Nest	Action 4: overflow beds and meals beyond what Arada gives in kind	AED 700,000 (US$190,600)	Pledge, released on an alert	500 × 7 nights × AED 200. Nest room rates AED 140–250 plus meals. Arada's in-kind share is not funded, to avoid duplication	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED

The funder's one thing: here the state pays for the infrastructure and for citizens. Philanthropy earns its place only in the non-citizen gap, and only if it is pledged now and released on an alert. A grant spent in a dry year is waste, so pledges should roll over if the season stays dry.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives here.

Do not wait in a stalled or queued car with the engine and air conditioning running and the windows shut *

CONTRAINDICATED

On 16 April 2024 in Sharjah, two Filipina women, aged 30 and 46, died of carbon monoxide poisoning in a car stuck in flood traffic. Sharjah Police said they "remained inside with the air conditioning running and the windows closed", and that the car "was completely sealed". Reports disagree on whether this was Al Ittihad Street or Al Wahda Street. These were the Sharjah deaths in that flood, and neither woman drowned.

Instead: if you are stuck, switch the engine off and open a window. If water is rising around the car, get out early. Better still, don't drive on alert days (action 1).

Do not go down to a basement or podium car park during the storm to move a car *

CONTRAINDICATED

In Valencia in October 2024, 32 of the 218 dead were found in garages and car parks, seven of them in one garage in La Torre, many having gone down to move their cars. Lifts fail and water blocks the doors. No UAE basement death is on record, but the Link buildings reportedly have two basement levels, and live power in floodwater has killed people in Sharjah in 2010 and 2025.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: move the car before the warning, 24–48 hours ahead of an NCM orange alert, or leave it. A car can be replaced.

Do not collect money for flood victims yourself, or through an unregistered group or a social-media appeal

CONTRAINDICATED

Under Federal Law No. 3 of 2021, only licensed bodies with a permit may raise funds from the public. An individual who does so faces prison and/or a fine, reported as AED 150,000–300,000 (check the statute's penalty article before relying on the figure), and the funds are confiscated. A well-meant appeal can put its organiser in court and lose the money.

Instead: give through Sharjah Charity International or the Emirates Red Crescent, or donate goods directly. Volunteer teams need a permit from the Sharjah Centre for Volunteer Work.

Do not pass on your own version of a warning, or a viral flood forecast

CONTRAINDICATED

In Derna, Libya, in 2023, residents received conflicting stay-at-home orders and evacuation calls, some coastal evacuees moved inland into the flood's path, and more than 11,000 died. This October the NCM has already had to dismiss viral posts claiming El Niño will flood the UAE. Its outlook is for wetter-than-normal conditions, not a forecast of floods. Rewording a warning in translation, or adding a prediction to it, creates exactly that confusion.

Instead: forward NCM and Sharjah Police alerts word for word, translated faithfully, and add nothing of your own.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
27 Feb 2010 El Niño (ONI +1.2)	36 mm of rain in Sharjah; deaths in the Industrial Area and Al Yarmook	3 dead in Sharjah from live wires in floodwater; 1 in Dubai	No documented change

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
9 Mar 2016 Strong El Niño, decaying (+1.7)	UAE-wide downpour; 287.6 mm in 24 hours at Al Shuwaib	No death found	Schools shut and stock-exchange trading cancelled for the day
10–11 Jan 2020 Weak El Niño (+0.7)	Heaviest rain in 24 years; Dubai and Sharjah streets flooded	1 dead in Ras Al Khaimah	No documented change
26–29 Jul 2022 La Niña (−0.7)	Fujairah and Kalba (Sharjah's east coast); Khor Fakkan Road closed both ways	7 dead; 3,897 sheltered	AED 50,000 per family whose home was damaged; wadi courses later ordered restored
14–16 Apr 2024 El Niño, decaying (+0.8)	Heaviest rain since records began in 1949; 254.8 mm at Khatm Al Shakla	4 UAE dead, all involving vehicles; 2 in Sharjah from carbon monoxide	Remote work and distance learning were called the day before; the Nest opened up to 3,000 places; compensation went to citizens and homeowners; the Middle Line drainage project followed
19 Dec 2025 La Niña (−0.6)	Rain-driven power outages in the Sharjah Industrial Area	2 electrocuted	No documented change
25–31 Mar 2026 Neutral (+0.1)	Sharjah city flooding; Al Majaz 3 worst hit, with the same shops flooded as in 2024	No deaths reported; 387 sheltered at the Nest in Aljada	Remote work left to department heads; 1,200 municipal staff deployed

The recurrence nobody has noticed: Sharjah's worst rain days fall in **February to April of a fading El Niño** (2010, 2016, 2024). That is the phase this event enters after its winter peak. So the riskiest window is February to April 2027, not this autumn, and it overlaps Ramadan. And in Sharjah city, people have not died in their homes. They died in cars, and from live power in floodwater. World Weather Attribution found that the 2024 event was 10–40% more intense than it would have been in a 1.2 °C cooler climate, and that "most previous heavy rainfall events in the

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

area occurred during El Niño years". It found cloud seeding "had no significant influence". ENSO values are NOAA's Oceanic Niño Index for the season centred on each event.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **Prepare now, for October and November** versus **prepare for February to April 2027**. The emergency manager worked to this autumn. The historian points to 2010, 2016, and 2024, all late-season storms in decaying El Niño years. The NCM's outlook leans late too ("particularly towards the latter part"). Both can be right: the actions have November deadlines, but the season to staff for is late winter.
- **Insure renters with a parametric rainfall policy** (economist) versus **it cannot be built in time** (verification). No retail rainfall product exists in the UAE, and there is no official gauge record at Sharjah Airport to calibrate one. It is a question for after the season, not a pre-peak action.
- **Fund the Nest shelter** (philanthropist) versus **Arada already pays for it in kind** (verification). Resolved by funding only overflow beyond Arada's share. Whether Arada would accept an outside pledge is untested.
- **Food is an El Niño risk here** versus **the war, not the weather, is the food risk**. The food lens found El Niño's food signal weak and late. A storm on the Khor Fakkan road matters only because the Hormuz conflict has already narrowed the supply route.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

Two gaps. **First, Aljada's own drainage.** No lens found how Aljada's streets and basements drain, or whether they flooded in 2024 or 2026. The briefing assumes they did not, from the absence of reports. A new master community, built on desert, may be better drained than central Sharjah or may simply be untested. Arada knows the answer and the public record does not. **Second, the labour camps.** No lens reached the residents of labour accommodation in Al Sajaa and Muwaileh directly. The outreach lens's advice is that they act on their employer's or supervisor's word, not an official's. That is why actions 1, 2, and 8 route through employers, but nobody has asked the workers.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale, roughly 300,000 people. They are not neighbourhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; drought, flood, fire, smoke, and crop failure are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED

METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The request named a single residential building in Aljada, Sharjah. It was widened to Aljada and the Muwaileh roads around it, the smallest unit with any evidence. Climate Impact Lab impact region, as the report records it: not resolved; the containing emirate is Sharjah. Mortality figures exist only at that scale (impact regions average roughly 300,000 people); sub-city detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It names no Gulf country, and no figure was scaled down to Sharjah. Heat is not this place's El Niño hazard. A UAE climate scientist quoted in October 2026 called El Niño's effect on UAE temperature "relatively weak". The historical record and the NCM outlook carry the rain hazard instead.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias (whether the evidence behind an agreed action came from a setting like this one) before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Seven separate verifier agents checked every recommendation on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the peak). Financial actions were also checked for availability in this jurisdiction, a named payer, a trigger threshold, and whether they already exist. The funding envelope was checked for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed. Food actions and the Hormuz claim had their own verifier, as did the historical record against NOAA's index.
- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Could not be consulted. The inventory page shows no entries until a country is chosen through its interactive filters, which the research tools could not operate. So "not accessible" on each card means unchecked, not "no precedent".
- **Money.** Costs are shown in UAE dirhams with US dollars in parentheses, at AED 3.6725 = US$1. That is the fixed peg the Central Bank of the UAE has held since November 1997. Its own site was unreachable, so the rate is confirmed from secondary sources, as of 21 October 2026.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (carbon monoxide in a running car, flood water, and underground car parks) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number with its arithmetic. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. Several primary pages (the Central Bank of the UAE, NOAA's ONI page, and AGBI) blocked direct reading, so their figures come from the same data in other copies. The NCM's own outlook document was not found; its wording is quoted from Gulf News. No source documents flooding in Aljada or Muwaileh. The Climate Impact Lab impact region was not resolved.

References · verification status in brackets

Place · The National, Aljada [confirmed] · Arabian Business, East Village [confirmed] · Link buildings listing [single source]

Outlook · Gulf News, NCM outlook [confirmed] · NOAA CPC, 8 Oct 2026 [confirmed] · NOAA ONI data [confirmed] · World Weather Attribution, 2024 [confirmed]

Deaths and record · The National, Sharjah CO deaths [confirmed] · Gulf News, Sharjah Police statement [confirmed] · Gulf Today, third death [confirmed] · Gulf News, Ras Al Khaimah death [confirmed] · The National, 2010 [confirmed] · Gulf News, 2016 [confirmed] · The National, 2020 [confirmed] · Khaleej Times, 2022 [confirmed] · Gulf News, Dec 2025 [confirmed] · The National, Mar 2026 [confirmed]

Response · Sharjah HR remote work, 2024 [confirmed] · WAM, May 2024 distance learning [confirmed] · MoHRE, Mar 2026 [confirmed] · Arada Foundation, Nest 2026 [confirmed] · WAM, Nest 2024 [confirmed] · SSSD, 2024 [confirmed] · Sharjah Municipality rain plan [confirmed] · Emarat Al Youm, Middle Line [confirmed] · Gulf Today, Middle Line 70% [confirmed] · The National, community aid 2024 [confirmed]

Health · Anderson & Bell 2012 [confirmed] · Kelman et al. 2015 [confirmed] · Andersson et al. 2015, Camino Verde [confirmed] · CDC EID, Aedes in Dubai [confirmed] · Gulf News, dengue response 2024 [confirmed] · Sharjah24, mosquito campaign 2026 [confirmed] · Gissing et al. 2019 [confirmed] · US National Weather Service [confirmed] · El Español, Valencia [confirmed] · Middle East Eye, Derna [confirmed]

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Money · Guy Carpenter 2024 [corrected] · Gulf News, motor flood cover [corrected] · Zurich survey via Gulf News [dated, about 2013] · UAE Cabinet AED 2bn [confirmed] · WAM, Sharjah compensation [confirmed] · Gulf News, AED 49.7m [confirmed] · Gulf News, SCI rain aid [confirmed] · WAM, fundraising law [confirmed] · Sharjah Executive Council, volunteer permits [confirmed]

Food · Al Jazeera, Hormuz [confirmed] · AGBI, rerouting [read via syndicated copy] · FEWS NET, Oct 2026 [confirmed] · Ministry of Economy, staples [confirmed] · CNBC, April 2024 [confirmed] · Gulf News, road closures 2022 [confirmed] · Gulftainer, Al Dhaid corridor [confirmed]

Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

Generated 21 October 2026 for Aljada, Muwaileh, Sharjah. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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